

Unit 8 Assessment

Regional Council Performance Task

Grade 3 Social Studies | Synthesis 2: The Regional Council | Week 23

Name: _____

Date: _____

Part A: Review Check

Choose the best answer.

1. Which region has hot, dry deserts and shares a border with Mexico?

- A. Northeast
- B. Southeast
- C. Southwest
- D. West

2. Which region is known for the Great Lakes, flat farmland, and cold winters?

- A. Southeast
- B. Midwest
- C. Southwest
- D. West

3. Why do curators use both maps and stories to describe a region?

- A. Maps are boring alone
- B. Stories are more fun
- C. Maps show where; stories show how people feel about a place
- D. Only one is needed

Part B: Council Chamber Scenario

Read the scenario. Then write your recommendation.

Scenario: A family wants to move somewhere with warm weather, good farmland for growing fruits and vegetables, and a city near water for trade. They have asked the Regional Council for a recommendation. Your job is to recommend one U.S. region and explain why it fits.

4. Which region do you recommend? Give at least two pieces of geographic evidence (climate, landforms, resources, bodies of water) to support your choice.

Part C: Virtue Reflection

5. Honesty and responsibility are the virtues for this synthesis. Why is it important for a Regional Council member to be honest about both the strengths AND the limits of a region?

Section	Points
Part A: Review Check (Q1–3)	3 pts
Part B: Council Scenario (Q4)	10 pts
Part C: Virtue Reflection (Q5)	4 pts
Total	17 pts

Unit 8 Assessment — Answer Key

Regional Council Performance Task

Part A (3 pts, 1 each)

1. C — Southwest
2. B — Midwest
3. C — Maps show where; stories show how people feel

Part B (10 pts)

4. **Secure (8–10):** Names a reasonable region (Southeast or West/California are strongest fits — warm weather, farmland, coastal trade cities). Gives 2+ geographic details that match the family's needs. Connects evidence to the request. **Developing (4–7):** Names a region with 1 piece of evidence or 2 vague ones. **Beginning (1–3):** Names a region with no geographic evidence.

Part C (4 pts)

5. **Secure:** Honesty = admitting a region has limits (e.g., hurricane season, water scarcity) alongside strengths; responsibility = giving advice you've thought through carefully. **Developing:** General. **Beginning:** Names virtue only.